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Pre-Class Materials

Greetings & Professional Introductions — Business English · Lesson 1

Demo Class · A2-B1+ · June 2026

Pre-Class Reading: The Art of Professional Introductions

When you meet someone for the first time in a **professional** setting, you have approximately seven seconds to make a first **impression**. That's it. Seven seconds. Before you even finish your first sentence, the person in front of you has already formed an opinion — about your confidence, your competence, and whether they want to work with you. This is known as the **7-second rule**, and it's why mastering the art of professional introductions is one of the most valuable skills in business English.

A strong professional introduction follows a simple three-step structure: **Present** → **Past** → **Future**. First, you state who you are right now — your name, your role, your current position. "Good morning, everyone. My name is Sarah Chen. I'm a marketing director at GlobalTech." This grounds the listener. It gives them the essential facts. Second, you share your **background** and **experience** — where you've been, what you've done, what you've learned. "I've been leading the Asia-Pacific team for three years. Previously, I built a marketing department from scratch at a startup in Shanghai." This establishes credibility. Third, you look forward — why you're here, what you hope to achieve, what comes next. "I'm here today to learn more about B2B marketing trends and to meet potential collaborators. I'm **looking forward to** the discussions ahead." This shows purpose and creates an **opportunity** for connection.

However, **cultural differences** play a significant role in how introductions are received. In many Western business cultures, a firm **handshake** and direct eye contact convey confidence and trustworthiness. A weak handshake or avoiding eye contact can be interpreted as nervousness or dishonesty. In East Asian cultures, a slight bow or a gentler handshake may be more appropriate, and sustained eye contact can sometimes feel confrontational. The key is adaptability — read the room, observe what others are doing, and adjust accordingly. **Confident** body language is universal: stand tall, keep your shoulders back, and avoid **glancing** at your phone.

There are also common mistakes to avoid. Never begin with "Myself [Name]" — this is a direct translation error from several languages including Hindi, but in English it sounds awkward and ungrammatical. Don't speak too fast — nerves can make you rush, but a measured pace signals control. Don't recite your entire CV — a professional introduction is not a biography. It's an **elevator pitch**: 30 seconds that tell someone who you are, why you matter, and why they should care. Keep it concise, keep it relevant, and always end with warmth. "It's a pleasure to meet you" or "Thank you" is far better than trailing off or saying "that's it."

Finally, remember that introductions are the beginning of a conversation, not the end of one. The goal is not to impress — it's to **connect**. Building **rappport** is more important than sounding impressive. Ask questions. Show genuine interest in the other person. At a **networking** event, the person who listens well is often remembered more fondly than the person who talks the most. A good introduction opens the door. A good conversation walks through it.

 Pre-Class Lexicon — Key Vocabulary (1/2)

Word / Phrase	Phonetic	中文	Source	Example
greeting	/ˈɡriːtɪŋ/	问候	Reading	"A proper greeting sets the tone."
impression	/ɪmˈpreʃən/	印象	Reading	"You have 7 seconds to make a first impression."
introduce	/ˌɪntroʊˈdjuːs/	介绍	Video	"Let me introduce myself."
professional	/prəˈfeʃənəl/	职业的; 专业的	Reading	"A professional introduction follows a structure."
colleague	/ˈkɒliːg/	同事	Video	"I look forward to working with my new colleagues."
background	/ˈbækgraʊnd/	背景	Video	"Let me give you some background."
experience	/ɪkˈspɪəriəns/	经验	Both	"I've been working in this field for over eight years."
specialise	/ˈspeʃəlaɪz/	专攻; 擅长	Video	"I specialise in digital marketing."

Pre-Class Lexicon — Key Vocabulary (2/2)

Word / Phrase	Phonetic	中文	Source	Example
opportunity	/ˌɒpəˈtjuːnəti/	机会	Reading	"This is a great opportunity to connect."
networking	/ˈnetwɜːkɪŋ/	社交；建立人脉	Reading	"At a networking event, listening matters more than talking."
handshake	/ˈhændʃeɪk/	握手	Reading	"A firm handshake conveys confidence."
elevator pitch	/ˈelɪveɪtə pɪtʃ/	电梯演讲	Reading	"Your elevator pitch should be 30 seconds."
rapport	/rəˈpɔː/	融洽关系	Reading	"Building rapport is more important than sounding impressive."
confident	/ˈkɒnfɪdənt/	自信的	Both	"Sound confident but not arrogant."
glance	/ɡlɑːns/	一瞥；扫视	Reading	"Avoid glancing at your phone during introductions."
collaborator	/kəˈlæbəreɪtə/	合作者	Video	"I'm here to meet potential collaborators."

✓ Section A: Matching (8 items)

Match each phrase (1–8) with its correct meaning (a–h). Write the letter in the blank.

- "Good morning, everyone" → ____
- "I specialise in" → ____
- "I'm looking forward to" → ____
- "Please feel free to" → ____
- "I've heard great things about" → ____
- "Previously, I worked at" → ____
- "It's a pleasure to meet you" → ____
- "I'm responsible for" → ____

Meanings:

- A formal greeting for a group
- My main area of expertise is...
- I am excited about (a future event)
- You are welcome to...
- People have told me positive things about...
- In the past, my job was at...

g) A polite and warm closing statement

h) My duties include...

✓ Section B: Multiple Choice (5 items)

Choose the best answer based on the reading passage and pre-class video. Circle the letter.

1. According to the reading, how long do you have to make a first impression?

- ☐ a) 30 seconds
- ☐ b) 7 seconds
- ☐ c) 1 minute
- ☐ d) 5 seconds

2. What is the correct order of the 3-step introduction formula?

- ☐ a) Past → Future → Present
- ☐ b) Future → Present → Past
- ☐ c) Present → Past → Future
- ☐ d) Past → Present → Future

3. Why is body language important in professional introductions?

- ☐ a) It replaces the need for words
- ☐ b) It conveys confidence and approachability
- ☐ c) It is not important if you speak well
- ☐ d) Only in Asian cultures

4. What is a common mistake in professional introductions?

- ☐ a) Speaking too clearly
- ☐ b) Making eye contact
- ☐ c) Using a firm handshake
- ☐ d) Saying "Myself [Name]"

5. Which phrase is best for ending a professional introduction?

- ☐ a) "That's it."
- ☐ b) "I'm done."
- ☐ c) "Thank you."
- ☐ d) "Bye."

Answer Key

Section A: Matching Answers

1. **a** — "Good morning, everyone" is a formal greeting for a group.
2. **b** — "I specialise in" means "my main area of expertise is..."
3. **c** — "I'm looking forward to" expresses excitement about a future event.
4. **d** — "Please feel free to" is a polite way of saying "you are welcome to."
5. **e** — "I've heard great things about" means people have told you positive things.
6. **f** — "Previously, I worked at" refers to a past job.
7. **g** — "It's a pleasure to meet you" is a polite and warm closing statement.
8. **h** — "I'm responsible for" means "my duties include."

Section B: Multiple Choice Answers

1. **b) 7 seconds** — The reading explicitly states the 7-second rule.
2. **c) Present → Past → Future** — First state who you are, then your background, then why you're here.
3. **b) It conveys confidence and approachability** — Body language reinforces your spoken message across cultures.
4. **d) Saying "Myself [Name]"** — A direct translation error. In English, use "My name is" or "I'm."
5. **c) "Thank you."** — A warm, professional close. Other options sound abrupt or too casual.

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